

KAT FEDOROVA

LLM Engineer — AI Evaluation & Quality

7 years as a Software Developer in Test, now building and evaluating LLM systems

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SUMMARY

I build and test AI systems. Seven years in quality engineering as a Software Developer in Test, then two years moving into AI engineering and evaluation: building LLM products end to end, and working out how you test, measure and trust systems that don't behave deterministically. I used a deliberate gap to study LLMs and evaluation in depth, ship products from idea to production, and complete the Harvard Business School Online CORE credential to understand what a business actually needs from engineering. Persistent, and I finish what I start — a two-year self-directed retraining is decent proof of that.

SKILLS

LLM engineering: Claude (Anthropic) API, OpenAI API, AWS Bedrock; prompt design and versioning, structured outputs / JSON schema, function and tool calling, RAG (embeddings, chunking, vector search with pgvector/Qdrant, retrieval evaluation), multi-step agents, MCP servers, provider abstraction with automatic fallback, streaming, caching, token/latency/cost optimisation

AI evaluation: Eval-set and rubric design, golden datasets, labelling guidelines and inter-annotator agreement, LLM-as-judge with human calibration, prompt regression testing, side-by-side model comparison and A/B testing, statistical significance and confidence intervals for eval results, groundedness and hallucination checks, output quality and consistency metrics, quality gates in CI, promptfoo, Ragas, DeepEval, Langfuse / LangSmith tracing and observability

AI safety and reliability: Red-teaming, prompt injection and jailbreak testing, guardrails and refusal behaviour, PII handling, failure-mode analysis, testing non-deterministic systems

Engineering: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Kotlin Multiplatform, Java, C#; SQL, FastAPI, Git, Docker, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, API and contract testing, CI/CD pipeline ownership

EXPERIENCE

LLM Engineer | TomatoPaws — cross-platform desk-break app (iOS, Android, web) Apr 2025 – present

- Develop and test a Kotlin Multiplatform app end to end — engineering, testing and release.
- Building an LLM feature generating personalised break suggestions: one LlmClient interface behind two providers (Claude and OpenAI), switchable by config with automatic fallback.
- Designing the evaluation: a labelled input set, a scoring rubric (relevance, safety, tone, length), side-by-side model comparison, and a CI job that fails on regression.
- Daily use of Claude Code, OpenAI Codex CLI and MCP-based agent tooling for development and testing.

Career break — transition into AI Apr 2024 – Apr 2025

- Deliberate year to move from traditional QA into AI engineering and evaluation: self-directed study of LLMs, evaluation methods and non-deterministic testing.

Senior Software Developer in Test | Covantis, Switzerland (remote) Apr 2022 – Apr 2024

- Built an internal LLM proof of concept to summarise and prioritise urgent work items; defined acceptance criteria and evaluated output quality against a rubric before rollout.
- Shifted the testing model from an ice-cream cone to a testing pyramid — release frequency went from one per month to roughly seven per day.
- Cut release validation from 1.5 hours to 4 minutes; reduced the end-to-end suite from 400 to 250 tests while increasing release confidence.
- Led design of the automation framework (Playwright, TypeScript, Python); owned GitLab CI pipelines and quality gates; security champion.

Senior Software Developer in Test | Polytech Software, Ukraine (remote) Nov 2020 – Mar 2022

- Migrated the test framework from C# to TypeScript; built an in-house npm test library reused by other Scrum teams. Mentored 4 junior engineers.

Middle Software Developer in Test | Valor Software, Kharkiv, Ukraine Sep 2019 – Nov 2020

- Led a team of 3; built the test framework, strategy and processes from scratch (TypeScript, Protractor).

Junior QA Automation Engineer | Taxer, Kharkiv, Ukraine Sep 2017 – Sep 2019

- Raised automation coverage from 30% to 80%; migrated the framework from Selenium/Java to Protractor/TypeScript.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Amazon Web Services | AWS Certified AI Practitioner 2026

Harvard Business School Online | CORE Credential (Business Analytics, Economics, Financial Accounting) Jan – Jul 2026

Terra Business School | Business mentorship programmes Apr – Nov 2025

National Technical University “Kharkiv Polytechnic Institute” | MSc, Computer Science 2018 – 2020